1. Workflow + problem

Preparing the application takes careful matching work

- Applicant gathers project documents and matches them to municipal instructions
- Missing or conflicting information can create avoidable follow-up and rework
- Hypothesis buyer (unvalidated): repeat professional applicants — to confirm in pilots

Prototype scope — see status.md

2. Walkthrough

Planned pipeline — verify status.md before presenting as working

- Step 1 — document text: upload project files into a browser-local workspace
- Step 2 — validated extraction: key facts pulled with evidence quote + page
- Step 3 — official rule pack + evidence check → cited readiness report

Prototype scope — see status.md

3. Rules vs optional AI

Rules decide; AI only helps read (pending until final integration)

- Official rule pack: which requirements apply given project facts; unknowns stay unknown
- Validated extraction first; AI-assisted reading labeled per field when enabled
- AI pending until final integration — workspace runs without it; nothing decided by AI alone

Prototype scope — see status.md

4. Architecture + privacy

Your files stay in your browser

- Workspace records live only in the visitor's browser; no signup; synthetic demo data
- Server reads files to extract text, then forgets them — originals not retained
- No municipal integration or submission; scans may need manual text or expert review

Prototype scope — see status.md

5. Landscape + pricing

A narrow preparation step; pricing still to test

- Others describe wider roles: full-service filing help, expert plan review, government systems
- PermitPath tests one step only: readiness before filing — see research.md (2026-10-10)
- Pricing hypothesis (unvalidated): per-project or subscription — discovery only

Prototype scope — see status.md

6. Next validation

Pilots measure frequency, time cost, willingness to pay

- Customer pilots: observe real preparation work; count missing-item catches + false flags
- Professional items always route to human verification; every report carries a disclaimer
- Final deck will be updated with actual verified capabilities + URL from the lead

Prototype scope — see status.md